

[Return to Search](#)

Village of curers and assassins

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KINTERMS DENOTING ALLIANCES WITH OTHER KALA AS CORPORATIONS • THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN KALA

KINTERMS DENOTING ALLIANCES WITH OTHER KALA AS CORPORATIONS

	<i>ngala wolo</i> : mother's mother's brother.	601 Kinship Terminology
	<i>maa</i> : father's mother, father's mother's sisters (both older and younger), mother's mother, mother's mother's sisters (both older and younger).	601 Kinship Terminology
	<i>maling</i> : sister's children, sister's son's children.	601 Kinship Terminology
	<i>moie</i> : mother's brother's wives, sister's son's wives.	601 Kinship Terminology
	<i>molo</i> : wives' brothers, wives' fathers, sisters' husbands.	601 Kinship Terminology

■ *mpong*: wife, wife's sisters, husband, husband's brothers.

601
Kinship Terminology

THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN *KALA*

One may ask after looking at the above lists of kin lexemes if it is appropriate to refer to *kala* as corporations whose membership is determined by filiation with one's father, and that all other kinship relations are defined by particular alliances between one's own corporate patrilineage and other *kala*. The rationale for making that assumption was already stated in the assertion that corporate membership is defined by the practice of food taboos or *tinya*. Those persons who share the same *koli tinya* refer to each other with the expression "*ku ka kala tano*" [we are of one *kala*]. Such persons belonging to one *kala* cannot intermarry and have mutual access to each other's *mpong* [spouses]. Hence, whenever a woman has intercourse with any of her husband's brothers, fathers (both biological and father's brothers), or sons (as long as they are not her own), she cannot confess his names and thus cause him to pay the \$10 adultery fine to her husband.⁹

262
Diet

582
Regulation Of
Marriage

601
Kinship Terminology

613
Lineages

684
Sex And Marital
Offenses

835
Kinship Regulation Of
Sex

Additional evidence for the corporate nature of *kala* is the marriage rule obtaining between *ngala* [mother's brother] and *maling* [sister's child]. First generation marriages are forbidden between them whereas second generation marriages are preferred. In the first generation the *ngala* and *maling* treat each other as 'play husband and wife' in a daily joking relationship whereby sexual play with each other is permitted, but they are prohibited from having sexual intercourse. When a first generation female *maling* marries, her prospective husband must give her *ngala* a token payment (usually about \$2) since it is said that he is taking his wife from him. Second generation marriages, on **■** 188 the other hand, are encouraged between *ngala* and *maling* to such an extent that bride price is reduced or not demanded at all. Instead, the statement is made that the *maling* was already the *ngala*'s spouse from birth. When the marriage is complete, recognition is formally given to the return of a woman to the first wife-giving patrilineage as an equal exchange. Such marriages, it is said, strengthen relations between the two *kala* and insure that each will support and protect the other.

582
Regulation Of
Marriage

583
Mode Of Marriage

604
Avuncular And
Nepotic Relatives

613
Lineages

835
Kinship Regulation Of
Sex

⁹ This as a recognized rule is practiced more in some quarters than in others. For instance, on one occasion I witnessed a palaver in which a woman confessed her husband's brother's son's name. After a long discussion in the confessed's father's house, the matter was forgotten and no adultery payment was made.

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